FAITH WEKESA

Software Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Faith is a software engineer who takes a product from research to release. She turns user research into requirements using her product management training. She designs flows and screens in Figma. She builds the front end in React, Next.js and TypeScript. She builds the back end in FastAPI and PostgreSQL with secure, role-based access. She tests with test cases and Postman, then deploys on Vercel through GitHub. She has also built a RAG research assistant with ChromaDB and Groq and an n8n workflow with Gemini. She is seeking a software engineering role.

SKILLS

Product and Design
Product Management, User Research, User Flows, System Design, Figma

Frontend
React, Next.js, TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, Tailwind CSS

Backend and Databases
Python, FastAPI, REST APIs, PostgreSQL, SQLAlchemy, Supabase, Role-Based Access

Testing and Quality
Test Cases, Functional Testing, Postman, Vitest, Debugging

AI and Automation
RAG, ChromaDB, sentence-transformers, Prompt Engineering, Groq API, Gemini, n8n, scikit-learn

Delivery and Teamwork
Git, GitHub, Pull Requests, GitHub Actions, Jira, Agile, Vercel

EDUCATION

Diploma in Information Technology | Software Engineering Track
AkiraChix
February 2026 - Present

BSc. Urban and Regional Planning
Kenyatta University
August 2021 - April 2025

Product Management and Cyber Security
Short courses

REFERENCES

Sharon Akinyi Otieno
AI/ML Engineer
sharonakinyiotieno3@gmail.com

Mary Macharia
Backend Engineer
0797488020

Ethel Phiri
AI/ML Engineer
+260979914383

PROJECTS

FikaMarket | Agricultural Marketplace (Team Project)

A farmer-to-buyer marketplace for Zambia, built end to end with a team of four at AkiraChix.

- Researched why small-scale farmers lose income to middlemen across 5 sources (World Bank, FAO, CGAP, GSMA and FinScope) and compared 2 existing platforms, DigiFarm and AgriPay.
- Used product management training to turn the findings into requirements for 3 user types, including USSD access, local-language support, lead farmers and collection points within 5 to 10 km.
- Mapped the user flows and designed Figma wireframes and high-fidelity screens for the website, buyer app and lead-farmer dashboard, plus feature-phone flows for farmers without smartphones.
- Did system analysis and design with the team to define the roles and data model, and applied cyber security training to build authentication and role-based access for the 3 user types.
- Built the FastAPI and PostgreSQL REST API with SQLAlchemy for listings, orders and collection points, so a purchase can be followed from listing to pickup.
- Built the Next.js and TypeScript screens that call the API, with role-based views for farmers, lead farmers and buyers.
- Tested the sign-in, listing and order flows with written test cases and Postman, and debugged across the front end, API and database.
- Worked with teammates through GitHub pull requests and code reviews, planned in Jira sprints and deployed on Vercel.

Salon Booking Platform | Full Stack Booking System

A live booking website for a Nairobi nail studio with WhatsApp confirmation.

- Scoped the system around the owner's needs, choosing WhatsApp confirmation because a nail technician rarely checks email, and built a responsive React and Vite front end with a gallery and booking calendar.
- Modelled bookings in PostgreSQL on Supabase with authentication and row-level security, a limit of 2 bookings per phone number and 3 statuses (pending, confirmed or declined).
- Integrated WhatsApp so the customer's chosen style and message reach the owner in one tap, and built a private owner dashboard with a Today view.
- Deployed on Vercel from GitHub and fixed live issues such as missing environment variables.

Naifix | AI-Assisted Urban Intelligence Platform

A platform concept that helps Nairobi authorities understand recurring community issues.

- Researched how recurring urban issues are handled and turned the findings into needs for residents and authorities.
- Designed 3 core pieces, an issue-reporting interface, a live issue map and a City Insights page, so residents can report problems and authorities can see them in one place.
- Built the dashboards as reusable TypeScript components using Lovable, presenting reports as patterns and trends, and explored AI-assisted analysis to flag emerging hotspots.

Research Assistant | RAG Pipeline over 43 Research Papers

November 2026. Answers from 43 arXiv papers with exact citations and declines when unsure.

- Extracted and cleaned text from 43 PDFs with PyMuPDF, split it into 4,127 chunks and embedded them locally with BAAI/bge-small-en-v1.5, then stored them in ChromaDB for cosine search.
- Added a similarity gate at 0.45 so weak matches skip the model, and a grounded prompt on the Groq API (gpt-oss-120b) with a check that every cited chunk was really retrieved.
- Evaluated it on 10 questions with checks run in code: 7 of 10 correct, the right chunk retrieved for 7 of 8 in-scope questions and both out-of-scope questions declined. Built a web chat page with source links.
- Built an n8n workflow with Google Gemini to refine prompts, and practised with scikit-learn models.